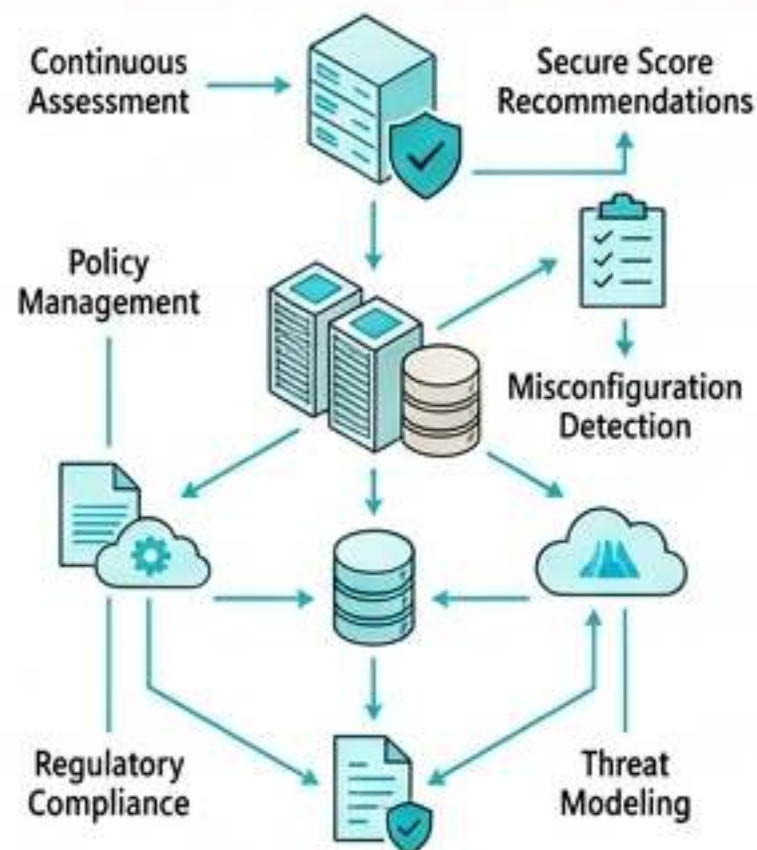


Microsoft Defender for Cloud

The Unified CNAPP Guide & AZ-500 Reference

PROACTIVE POSTURE (CSPM)



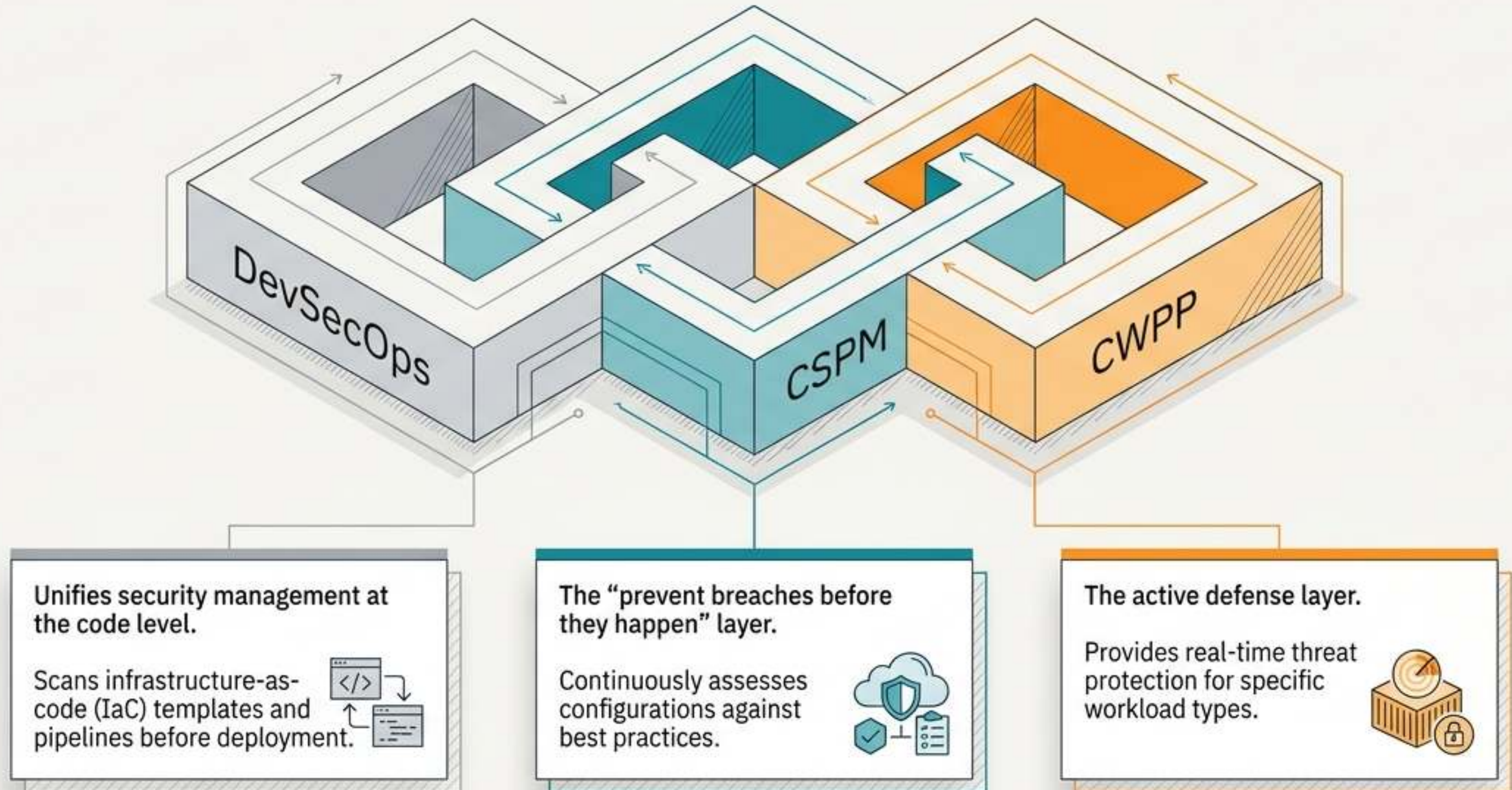
REACTIVE THREAT DETECTION (CWPP)



EXTERNAL BOUNDARIES & MULTICLOUD (EASM)



The CNAPP Triad



The Core Distinction: Proactive Posture vs. Reactive Defense

Am I configured securely?



Is something attacking me?



Key Insight: **CSPM** tells you a storage account is publicly accessible. **CWPP** alerts you when an attacker is actively uploading malware. You inherently need both to eliminate blind spots.

The Posture Management Matrix

Feature Unlock

Defender CSPM (Paid, Premium)

Tells you which misconfigurations actually matter to an attacker

-  **Attack Path Analysis:** Maps exploitable chains
-  **Cloud Security Explorer:** Graph-based risk hunting
-  **Agentless Scanning:** Offline disk snapshot analysis
-  **Data & AI SPM:** Sensitive data & generative AI risks



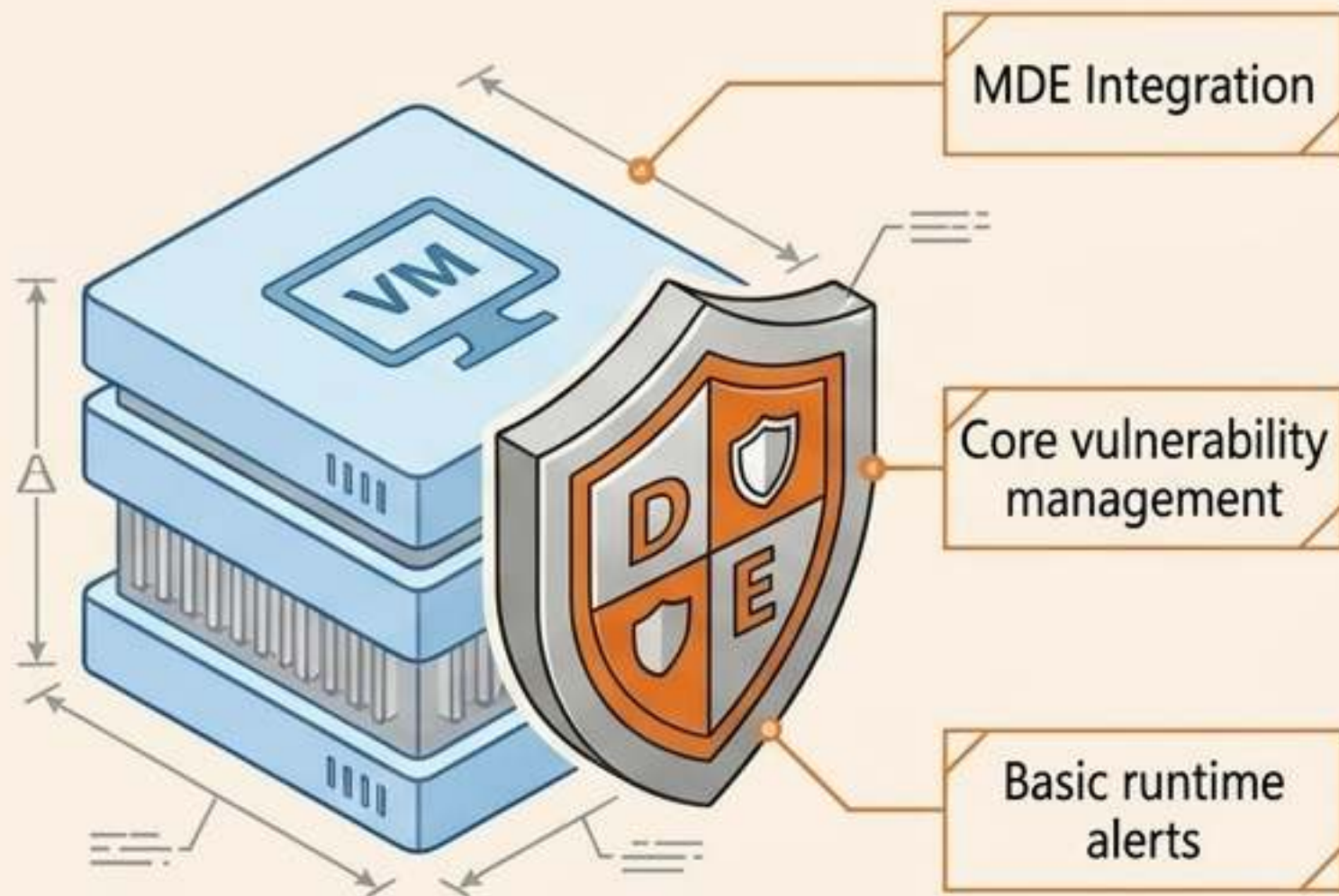
Foundational CSPM (Free, On by Default)

Tells you what is misconfigured

- Secure Score
- Asset Inventory
- Basic Recommendations
- Microsoft Cloud Security Benchmark (MCSB)

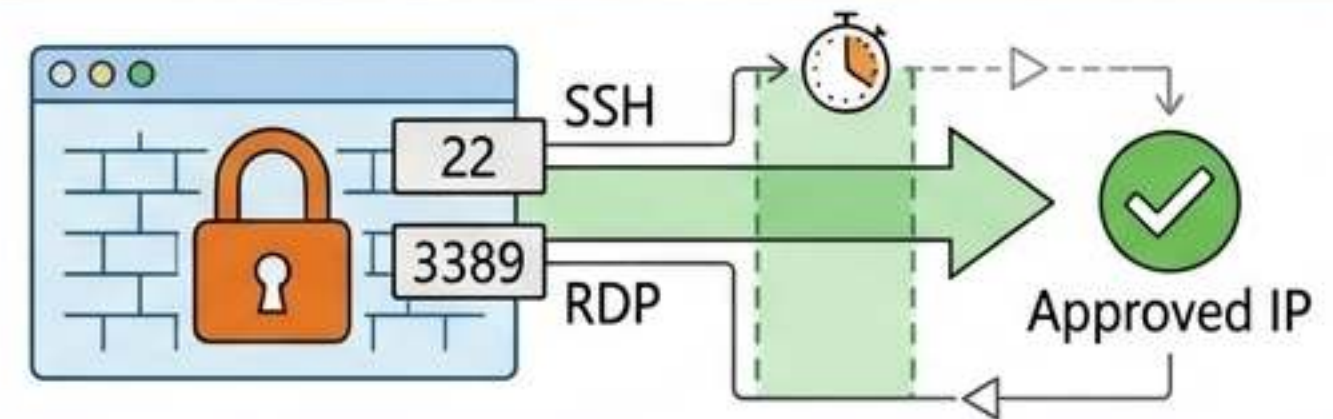
Compute Defense: Defender for Servers

Plan 1 (Baseline)

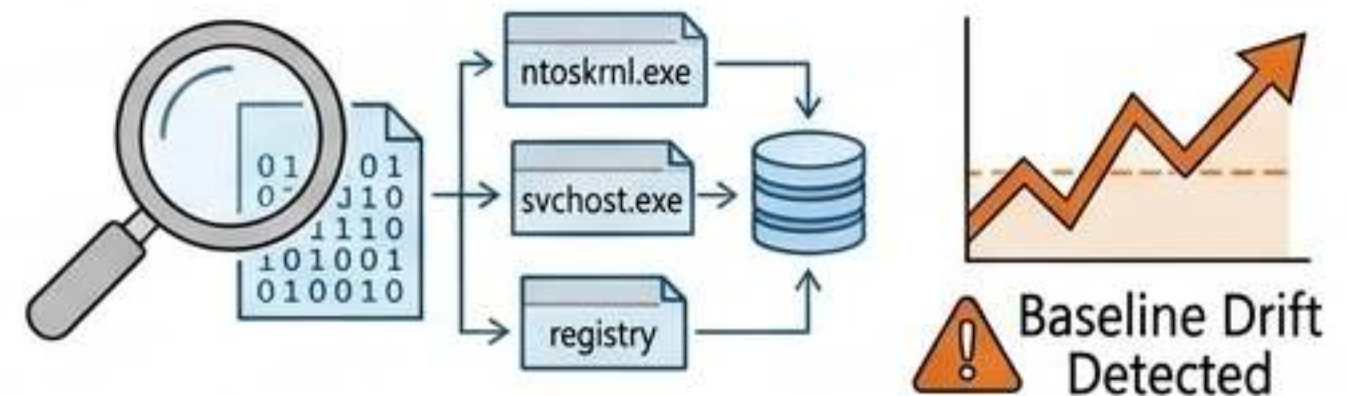


Plan 2 (Advanced Controls)

Just-In-Time (JIT) VM Access



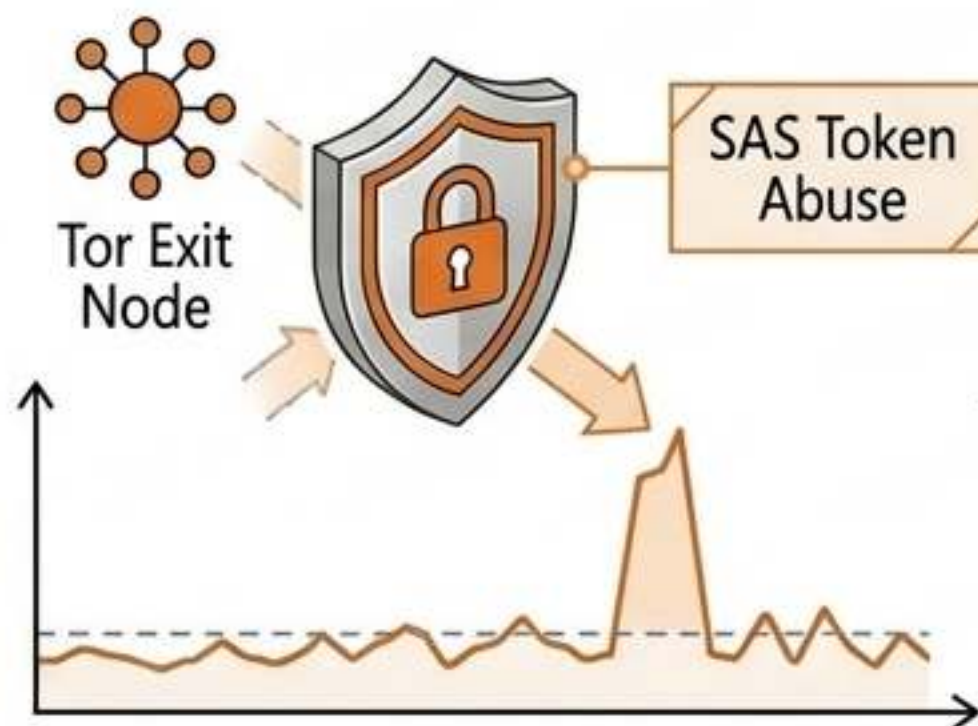
File Integrity Monitoring (FIM)



Includes 500 MB/day of free log ingestion per server.

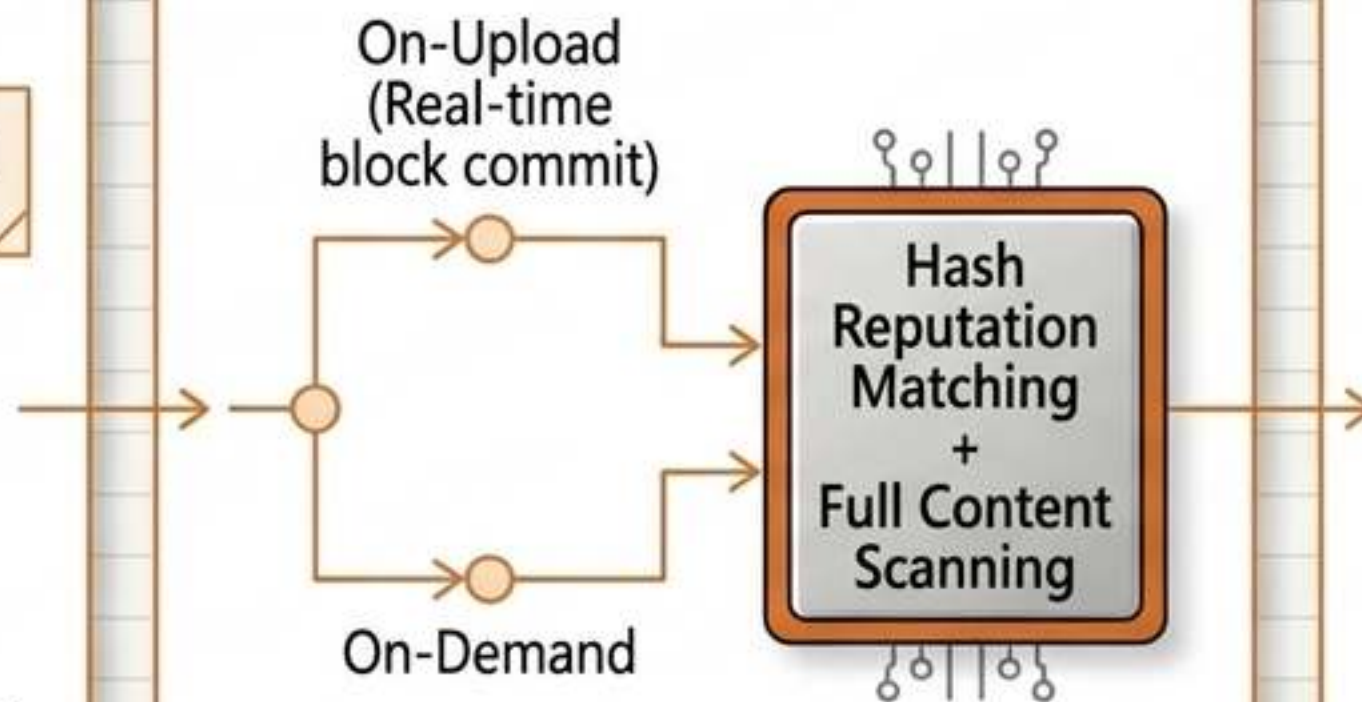
Data Defense: Defender for Storage

Activity Monitoring (Always On)

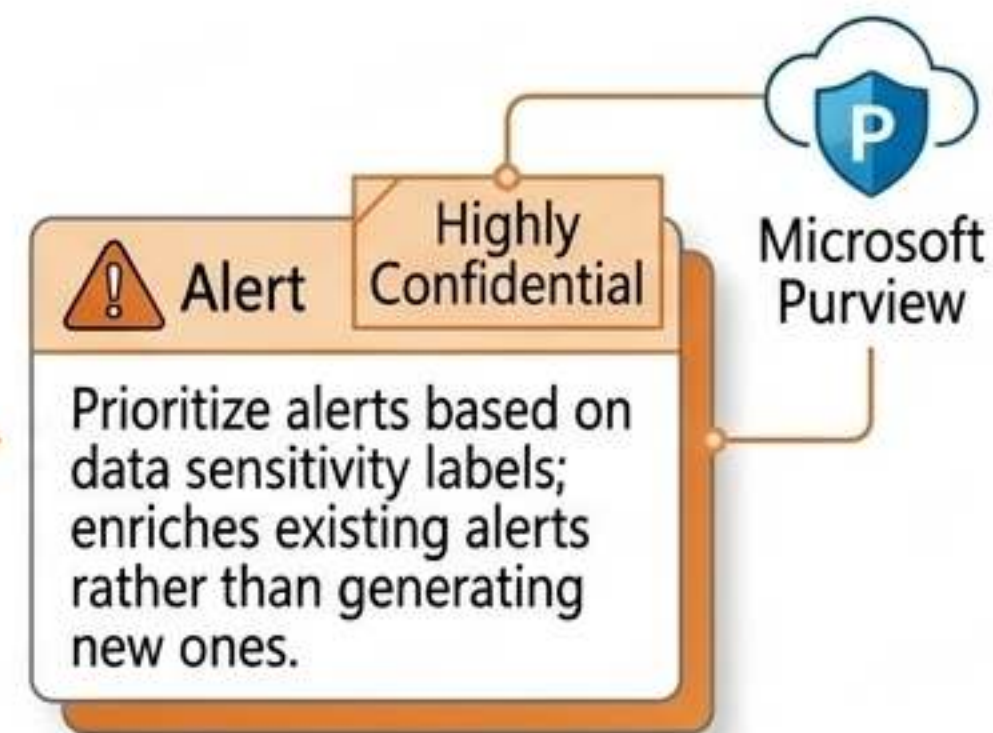


Analyzes data/control-plane activity for anomalous geography and non-human access patterns.

Malware Scanning (Configurable Add-on)

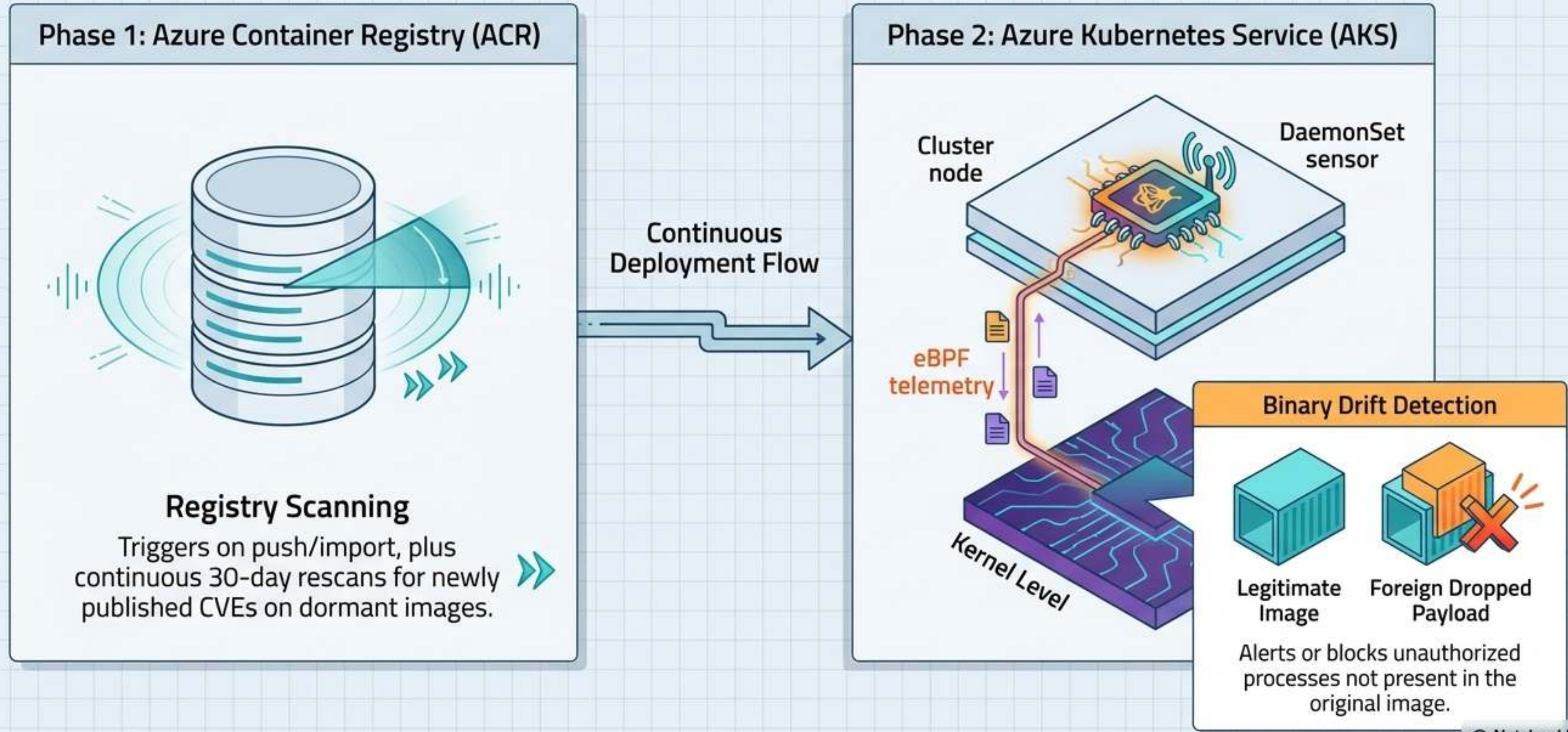


Sensitive Data Threat Detection (Enrichment)



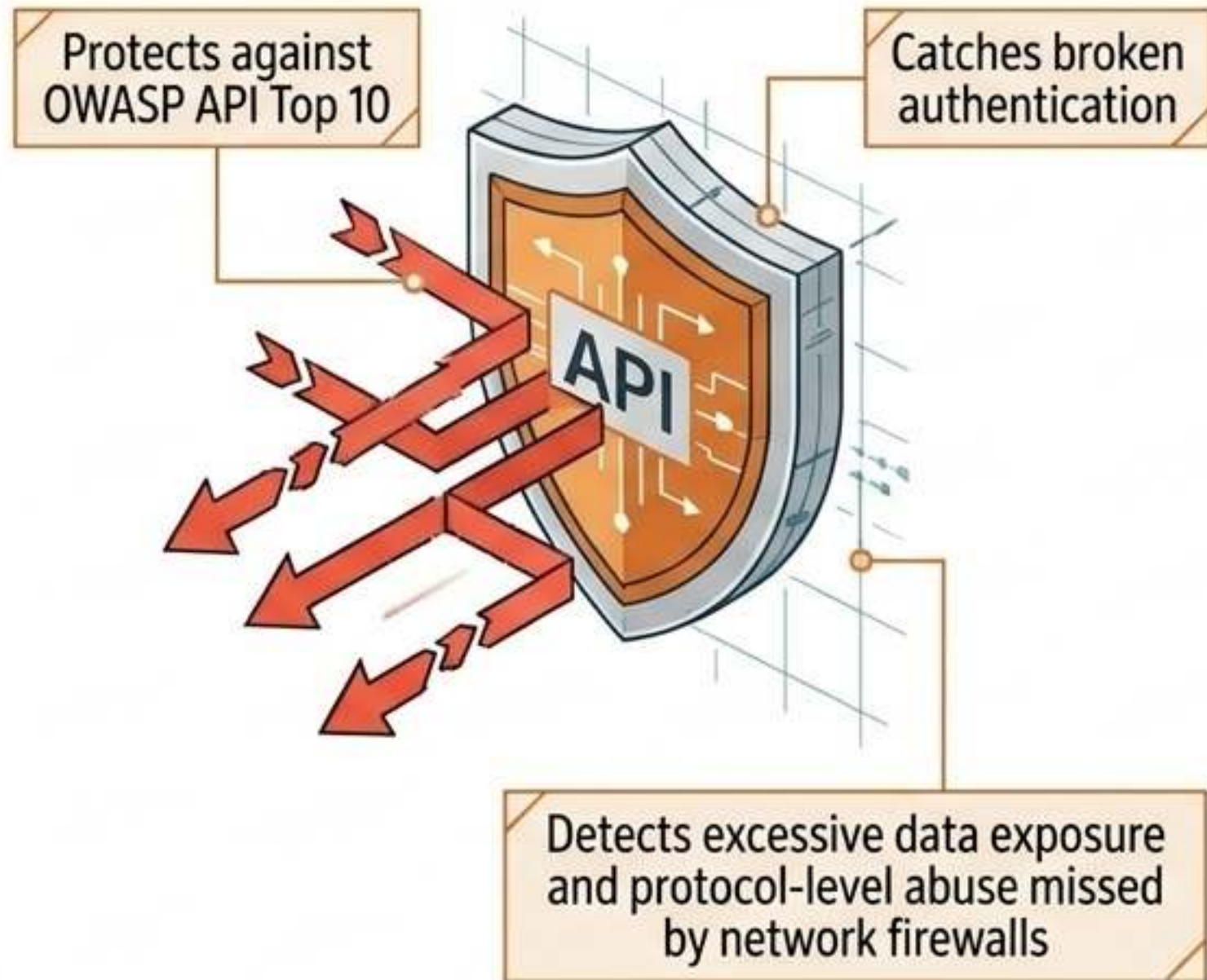
Prioritizes alerts based on data sensitivity labels; enriches existing alerts rather than generating new ones.

Cloud-Native Defense: Defender for Containers

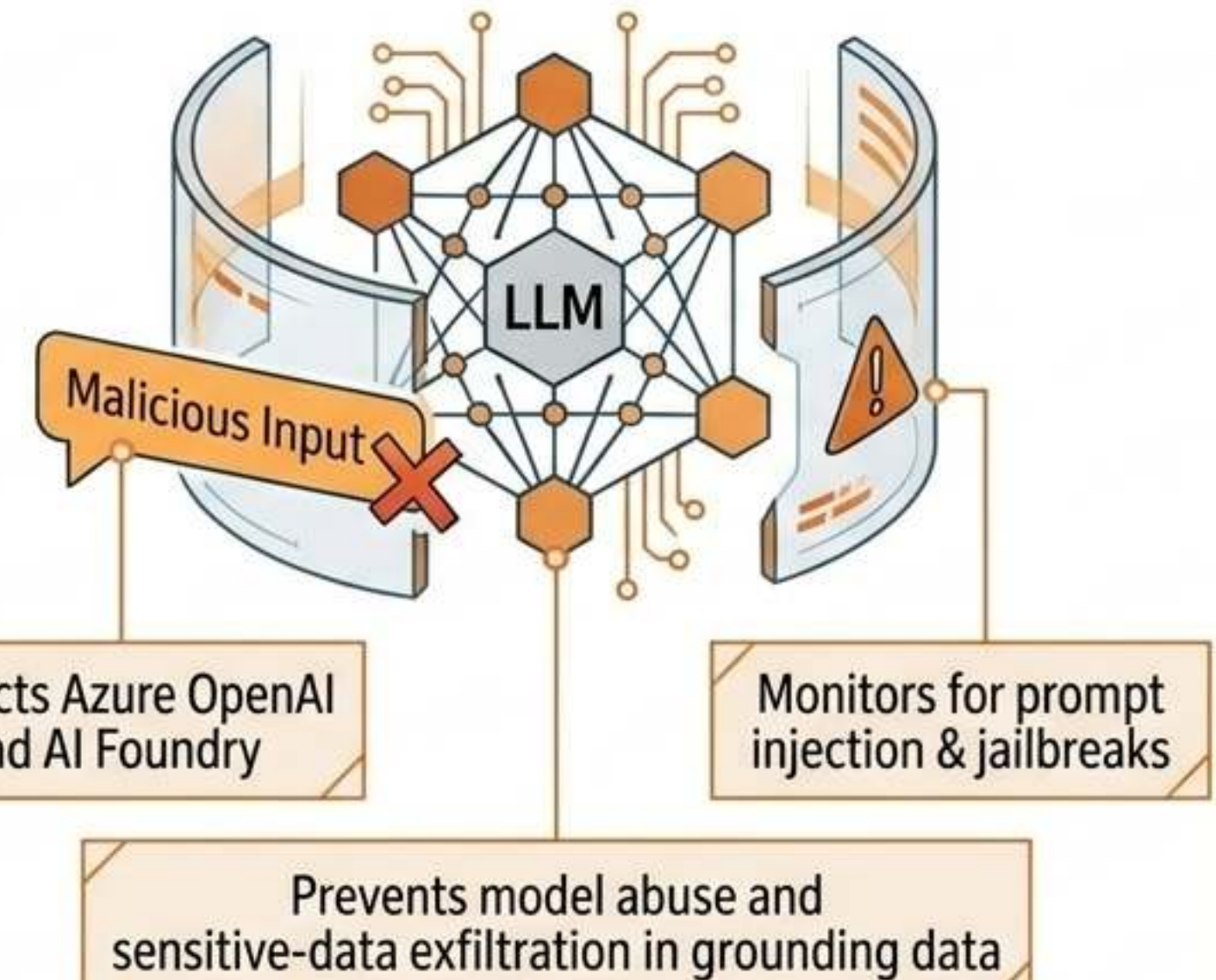


Modern Defenses: APIs & AI Services

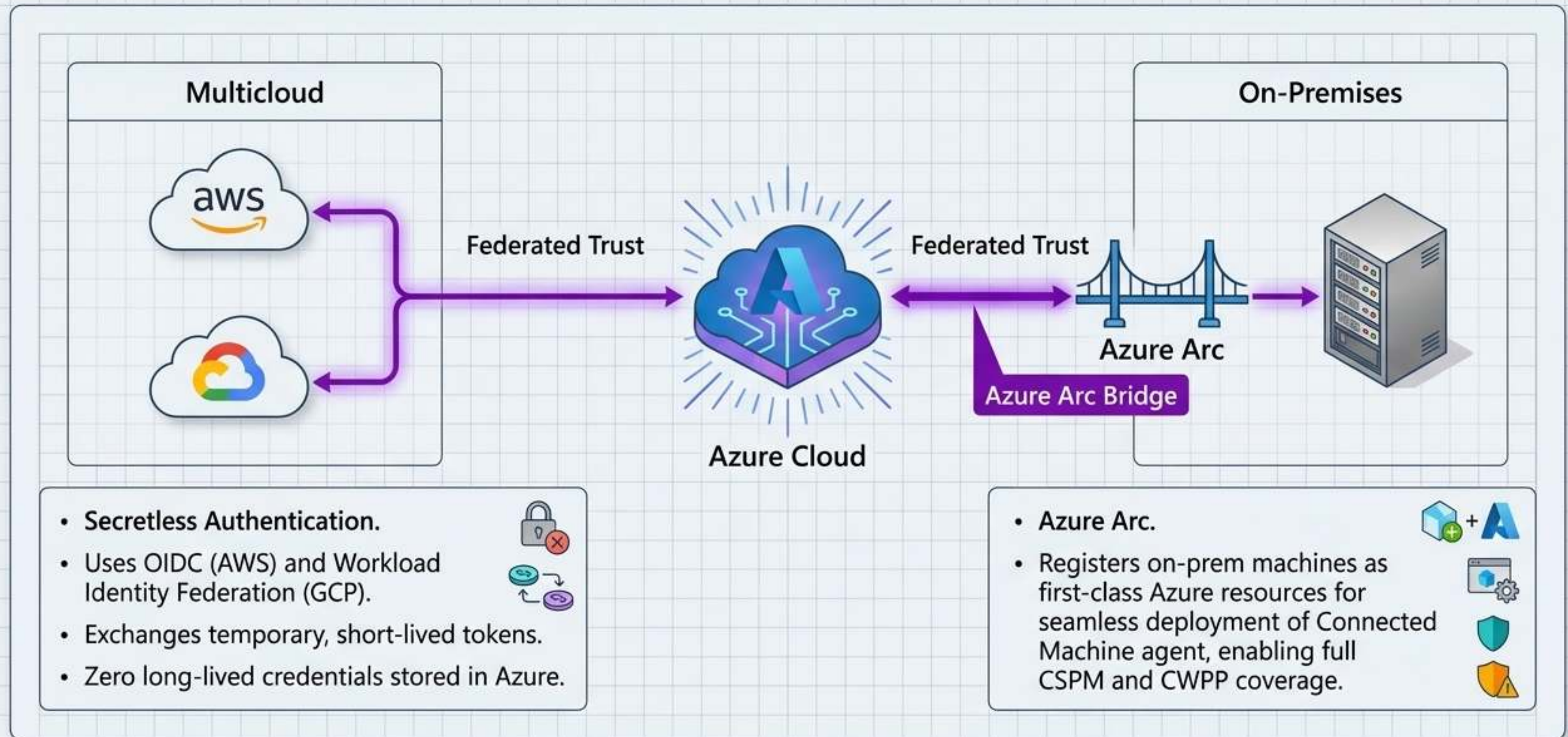
Defender for APIs



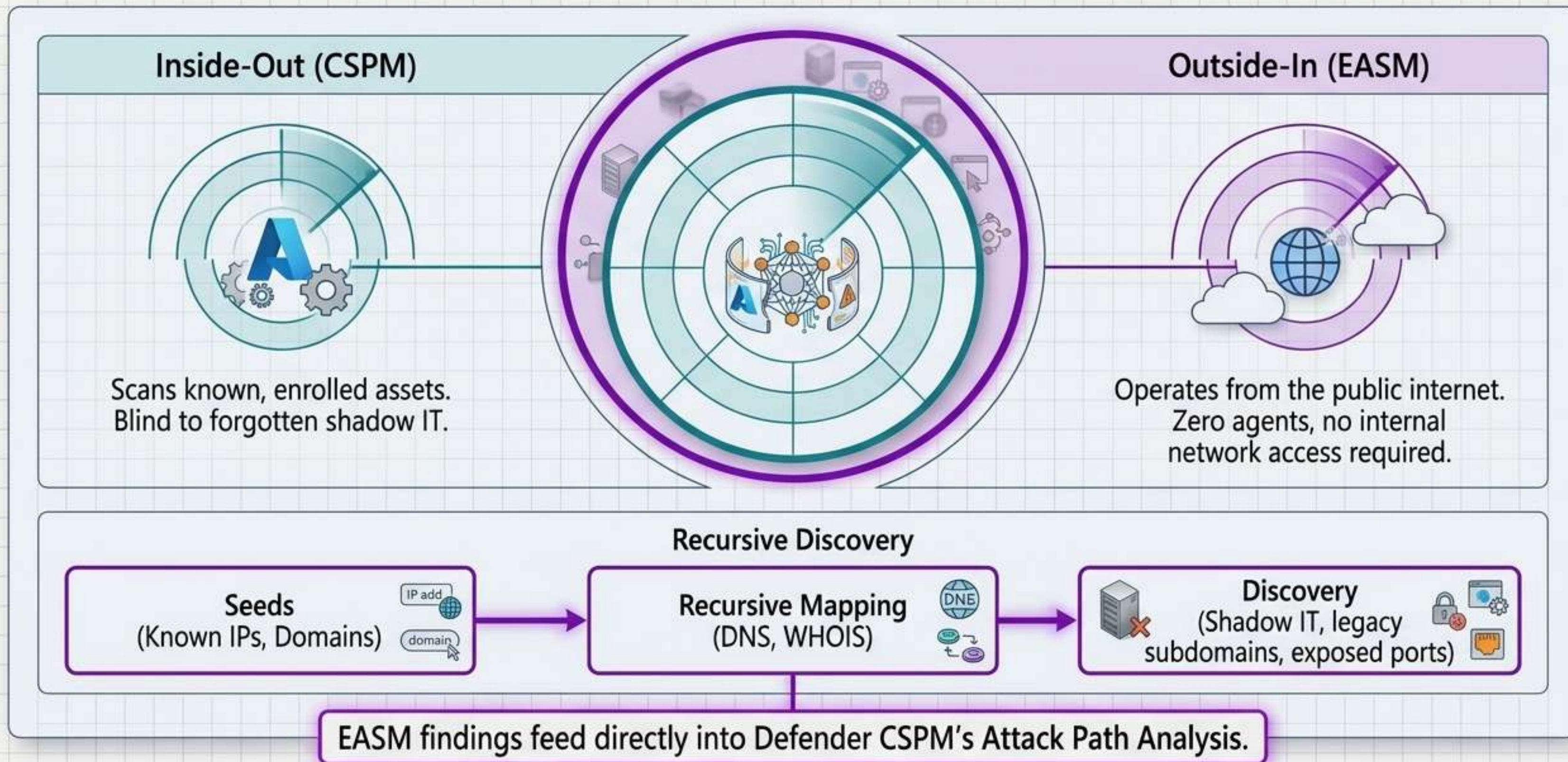
Defender for AI Services



Boundary Defense: Hybrid & Multicloud Connectors

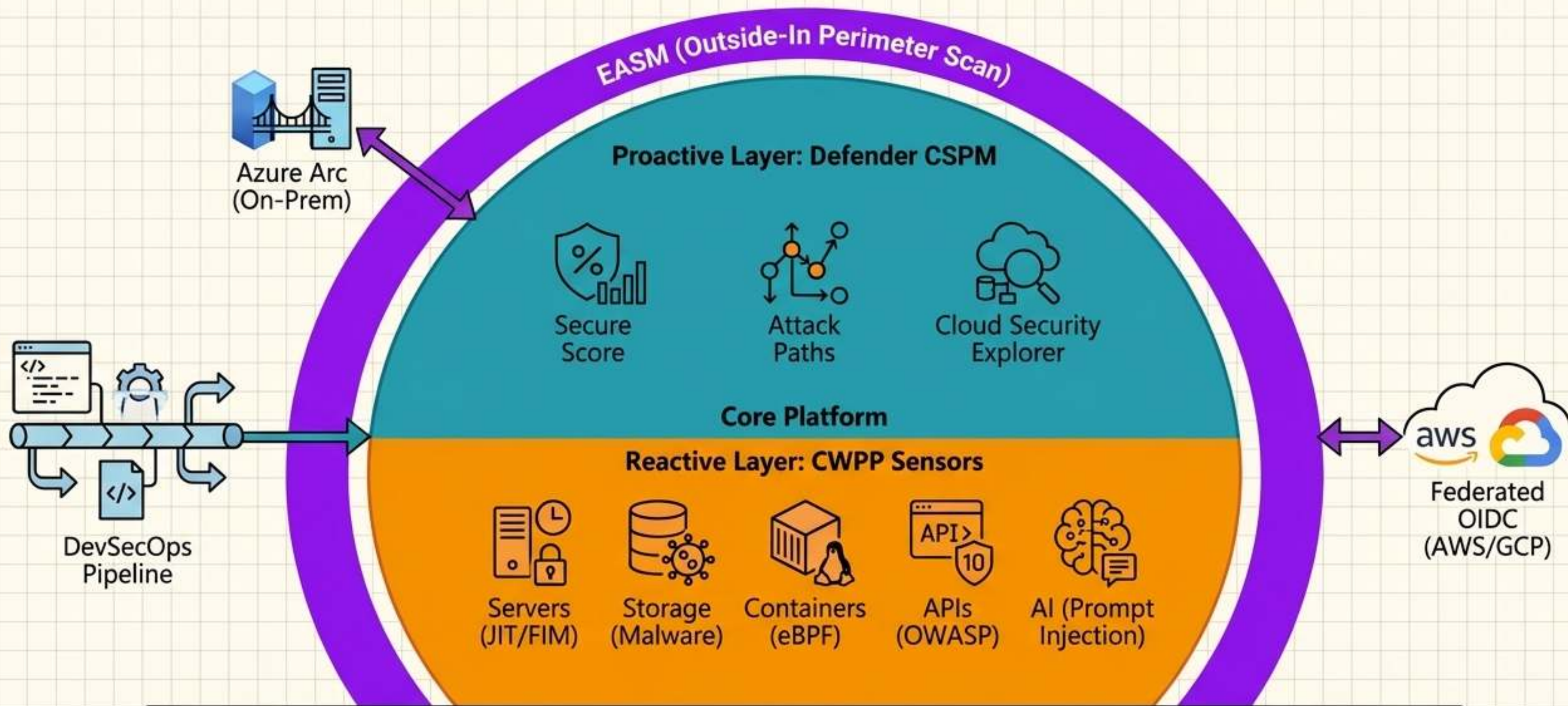


The Attacker's Perspective: External Attack Surface Management



Synthesis: The Unified CNAPP Topology

A master architectural blueprint mapping to the entire security ecosystem



A true Cloud-Native Application Protection Platform requires visibility from the code pipeline, proactive posture hardening of the platform, reactive runtime guards on the workloads, and an outside-in view of the perimeter.